Manchester Museum

Self guided tour and drawing practice

This tour will take you to the Living Worlds Gallery, Nature's Library Gallery, the Vivarium and the Fossils Gallery

Most of the questions need you to read the labels and carefully look at the specimens, a few will ask you to look things up and you are always welcome to ask any of the Museum staff for help as well.

Go in to the Museum and walk through the Shop then up the stairs to the Galleries. At the top of the stairs turn left into the Archaeology Galleries. Keep walking through Egypt and Sudan. As you come out of these galleries just before the glass bridge:

On your right you will see a case containing Maude. What is Maude – what was her father and what was her mother?

Maude is a ….....

Her father was ….....

Her mother was ….....

Do you think this would be allowed today and why not?

Go into the Living Worlds Gallery

Find the Weather Case – look at the animals listed below. Which of them were alive when the climate was warm and which of them were alive when it was cold?

Name of Animal	Cold/Warm?	How long ago did it live?
Reindeer		
Hyena		
Cave Bear		
Woolly mammoth		
Sea urchin		
Bison		
Sponge		

Look up at the whale skeleton – what type of whale is this? Was it a baleen or toothed whale?

Go up the stairs to Nature's Library

List some of the animals that were alive in the warm, shallow seas of the Jurassic era 199-145 ma.

Find the Coco de Mer seed pods – in your notebook draw a labelled sketch of one of the pods. Why are they so big and how are they transported from the parent plant.

Look for the cases with the corals and sponges – How many species of sponge are there thought to be/

Name the biggest sponge on display - draw a labelled sketch of this sponge in your notebook.

Go into the Vivarium

What class of animals does the chameleon belong to?

What class of animals do the frogs belong to?

Go all the way downstairs to the Fossils gallery on the ground floor

Firstly, have a look at April the *Tenontosaurus* – this is the fossil that used to be in our teaching labs

The gallery is laid out in order from oldest to youngest fossils. The questions on this assignment roughly proceed through the cabinets in that order. Start nearest April on the left hand side:

How did the soft bodies of Ediacaran fossils survive to become fossilized?

Fossils similar to the Burgess Shale were also found in China. What is the name of the location where the fossils were found?

During the Cambrian explosion brachiopods, archaeocyathids and graptolites first appeared. Which animals with 3 lobed bodies also made their first appearance?

Crinoids are similar to what extant form of sea life? Draw an example of a crinoid.

What is *Cooksonia*?

What percentage of Stan's bones have been found? How old was he when he died? When did he live?

What modern sea mammals do ichthyosaurs look like? How did the ichthyosaurs move their tails when they swam and how does that compare to the modern animal that looks like an ichthyosaur?

The trunk of the modern elephant evolved from what body part of early elephants?

I will post the answers to this quiz after next weeks class

I hope you enjoyed your visit to the Museum